# NHMEC Student

# Module 2.1

## BIBLICAL HERBALISM




# GUIDEBOOK

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# CHRISTIAN HERBALIST GUIDEBOOK

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AI Technologies

In crafting this book, advanced AI technologies have been utilized to assist in editing and grammar, ensuring clarity and precision in the text. These tools have enabled a streamlined process of refinement and accuracy, enhancing the overall quality of the content.

Book Overview

This book serves as an insightful guide for students of the NHMEC. It emphasizes the importance of understanding and using natural resources such as herbs, fields, and trees to foster well-being, while clearly stating that it does not intend to prescribe, diagnose, or offer medical treatment. Instead, the book's purpose is to educate readers on how these natural elements can support the body's natural healing processes. In this context, God is recognized as the ultimate healer, aligning with the Christian viewpoint presented throughout the text.

The author, Penny Lane Whittemore, brings over 30 years of extensive experience in various modalities and training to her teachings. Her deep involvement in numerous resources, ministries, companies, and educational initiatives is reflected in the comprehensive and well-rounded content of the book. She combines her rich background with practical insights, offering readers an opportunity to learn from her vast knowledge and experience.

This educational resource is crafted to guide students in understanding the integration of faith and holistic health practices. Through her teachings, the author encourages a thoughtful exploration of how Christians can responsibly and effectively incorporate natural remedies into their lives, all while maintaining the belief that God plays a crucial role in the healing journey.

# DIRECTIONS

Please adhere to the Guidebook, as it contains essential assignments, questions, and activities. Remember to follow these steps:

1. When you purchase the Program of Study (Course), you should receive a link to enroll in the Holistic Christian Herbalist Course. If you don't see the link, please check your email.
2. Carefully read and review the Student Handbook found in the Welcome & Orientation Module.
3. Complete the course as assigned by each module. The order of modules is important: some modules contain an entire class, while others have a link to a course. There are both classes and courses within the Program of Study.
4. Complete your internship and training.
5. Receive your accredited diploma of completion via mail.

To support your learning process, utilize note-taking, highlighting, sticky notes, etc. You can export all content to a PDF annotation app, including Canva.

Upon completion of this course, you will receive a Certificate of Completion and be eligible for a Diploma of Completion.

# STUDENT INFO

STUDENT NUMBER (LOCATED ON YOUR STUDENT ID CARD)
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NAME _____

CANVAS STUDENT LOGIN _____

PASSWORD _____

ENROLLED DATE _____

START DATE _____

NOTES;
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Please consult the CANVAS COURSE to fulfill these assignments. Following the CANVAS COURSE CLASSROOM closely is crucial for completing the course in its entirety.

MODULE 2.1 - Biblical Herbalism

- Biblical Herbalism PDF
- Video 1
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# HERBALIST DEFIND AS A CHRISTIAN

As a believer, I firmly believe that herbs can contribute to optimal health and wellness. However, discernment is crucial when studying herbalism in today's world. I have carefully questioned all things and allowed the Holy Spirit to guide me in making good choices, based on the principles of God and His word in the Bible.

I have learned from my experiences as a Christian and an herbalist, growing not only as a soldier but as a warrior and ambassador of Christ. My journey has taught me to be cautious about the path I choose, as I was once unknowingly headed towards worshiping the creation instead of the Creator. This included borderline practices of Wicca, White Witch, Sorcery, Witchcraft, and other occult practices.

If you are a Christian considering studying herbalism, discernment is crucial. Some Christians may be apprehensive about the potential dangers of learning herbalism, and there are reasons for this. On the other hand, God has created plants for us to use for our wellness and food.

I realized this when a group of Christian women approached me about teaching them what I knew. I was overwhelmed, delighted, scared, and confused. However, I knew that confusion and fear are not of God, and I trusted the discernment that God had given me. I revisited my old materials and realized that they were not aligned with God's word. I felt a release to start new classes, with a Christian perspective on herbalism using God's principles for a healthful living.

Currently, in the United States, herbalism is not a recognized health care modality. There is no state or national licensing board for herbal practitioners, and there are no recognized credentials or titles, including "master" herbalist or "certified" herbalist. However, certain independent entities, third-party organizations, or institutes not related to any governing legal boards do qualify individuals with certain titles, depending on their education and experience. I hold certification through a third party, the American Association of Nutritional Consultants AANC. I also hold diplomas from various institutes and certificates of completion from various institutes, along with hands-on training, mentorships, and self-teaching.

As a Christian, I believe in maintaining moral standards on a daily basis. We need to know what spirit we are of and what we are worshipping. It is easy to get influenced by demonic forces, world trends, movements, or theologies. However, everything we say, do, and live by will be held accountable. I urge Christians who are studying herbalism to pray for discernment and to take heed lest they fall. We need to be cautious about participating in ungodly events, as they can be influenced by spiritual deities, spirits, or remnants of evil spirits. These can transfer over to a Christian's lifestyle, flesh, way of thinking, and way of believing. We must study God's word to discern what is of Him and what is not.

In summary, I am confident in my faith and my pursuit of herbalism. I believe that the principles of God and His word in the Bible are crucial in making good choices. As a Christian herbalist, I aspire to teach other Christians how to use herbs for optimal health and wellness, while aligning with God's principles of a healthful living.

# THE ROLE OF A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

- In our modern society, a growing number of individuals are exploring alternative medicine to address their health issues. Herbalism is one such method that has been embraced for centuries by diverse cultures worldwide. This class will delve into the role of a Christian herbalist, defining who they are and what their practice entails.. Christian herbalists are practitioners who integrate their faith with the use of natural remedies to promote health and healing. They believe that God has endowed the earth with a wealth of plants and herbs that can support the body's natural healing processes. These practitioners see their work as a way to honor God's creation and to help others achieve wellness in a holistic manner.
- One of the primary roles of a Christian herbalist is to educate their clients about the benefits and uses of various herbs. They provide guidance on how to incorporate these natural remedies into daily life, whether through teas, tinctures, or topical applications, always ensuring that their recommendations align with both scientific knowledge and biblical teachings.
- Christian herbalists also emphasize the importance of prayer and spiritual well-being in the healing journey. They often incorporate prayer into their consultations, seeking divine guidance to better understand and address the individual needs of their clients. This spiritual component is seen as an essential part of the healing process, providing comfort and peace alongside physical remedies.
- Moreover, Christian herbalists advocate for a balanced lifestyle that encompasses not just physical health but also mental and spiritual wellness. They may offer advice on nutrition, exercise, and stress management, encouraging clients to adopt habits that foster overall well-being.
- In doing so, Christian herbalists aim to empower individuals to take charge of their health while nurturing their relationship with God. They serve as compassionate guides, supporting clients as they navigate their health journeys with faith and hope. Through their work, Christian herbalists strive to bring glory to God by helping others experience the healing and wholeness that He desires for all His creation.

# WHAT IS A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST?

- A Christian herbalist is an individual who practices herbalism while firmly rooted in their Christian beliefs. They hold the conviction that God has provided natural remedies through herbs and plants to aid in healing the body and enhancing overall health. Often, Christian herbalists combine prayer and scripture with herbal treatments to support their patients' healing journeys. They view their work as a ministry, serving others by integrating their faith with the wisdom of nature. Christian herbalists strive to honor God through their practice, believing that by utilizing the natural resources He has provided, they can promote wellness that aligns with His design for creation. They often emphasize the importance of faith, spiritual well-being, and a holistic approach to health, incorporating both physical and spiritual aspects in their healing practices. By doing so, they aim to foster a deeper connection between their clients and God, encouraging a lifestyle that reflects gratitude and stewardship for the natural world.

What do Christian Herbalists do?

- Christian herbalists utilize a variety of herbs and plants to address a spectrum of health concerns, ranging from minor issues to chronic conditions. They may formulate herbal remedies such as teas, tinctures, salves, or capsules, and recommend specific herbs for internal consumption or topical application. Additionally, they offer advice on dietary and lifestyle modifications to foster overall wellness and recovery.
- Beyond physical health, Christian herbalists also focus on the spiritual and emotional well-being of their clients. They may provide prayer and spiritual counsel, helping patients connect with God's healing power through the use of herbs and plants.
- Christian herbalists play a vital role in fostering holistic health and wellness, merging the principles of herbalism with Christian teachings. By employing natural remedies and incorporating prayer and scripture into their approach, they assist patients in achieving optimal health across body, mind, and spirit.
- In summary, Christian herbalists are committed to guiding others on their path to health and well-being through the use of herbs and plants, all while being anchored in their faith in God's healing capabilities. If you're interested in exploring herbalism from a Christian viewpoint, consider seeking a Christian herbalist who can offer you tailored care and support on your journey to improved health.
- Whether you're seeking relief from physical ailments, emotional struggles, or spiritual disquiet, a Christian herbalist can provide a compassionate and faith-driven approach to healing. They understand that each individual is uniquely crafted by God, and tailor their practices to honor and support this divine design. In doing so, Christian herbalists not only promote the use of God-given resources found in nature but also emphasize the importance of nurturing one's relationship with God as an integral part of the healing process.
- If you are embarking on this journey, remember that the path to wellness is a collaborative effort between you, your herbalist, and your faith. Embrace the holistic care and wisdom that a Christian herbalist can provide, allowing their guidance to illuminate your path to a healthier, more balanced life. In this way, you are not just treating symptoms but are engaging in a transformative process that seeks to heal the whole person—body, mind, and spirit—through the love and grace of God.

# THE CHRISTIAN HERBALIST: NURTURING BODY, MIND, AND SPIRIT

- Christian herbalists are devoted individuals who blend their deep faith in God with a passion for utilizing natural remedies to enhance health and wellness. By merging herbalism with Christian teachings, these practitioners provide a distinctive healing approach that addresses the complete individual – body, mind, and spirit. In this class, we will delve into the role of Christian herbalists in fostering holistic health, the guiding principles they adhere to, and their integration of prayer and scripture in their practice. Christian herbalists view the natural world as a divine gift from God, filled with resources intended to support human health. They believe that by using the plants and herbs God has provided, they can help individuals achieve a harmonious balance in their lives. This holistic approach not only treats physical ailments but also nurtures the emotional and spiritual well-being of their clients.
- A core principle guiding Christian herbalists is the belief that God is the ultimate healer. They see themselves as instruments through which God's healing power can flow, assisting others in their journey towards health and wholeness. This perspective fosters a deep sense of humility and service, as they recognize their role in the larger tapestry of God's creation.
- In practice, Christian herbalists often begin their consultations with prayer, inviting the Holy Spirit to guide their interactions and decisions. This spiritual foundation allows them to discern the specific needs of their clients and tailor their herbal remedies accordingly. Scripture readings may also be incorporated into their sessions, providing spiritual encouragement and grounding.
- Moreover, Christian herbalists emphasize the importance of lifestyle choices that align with biblical teachings. They encourage their clients to adopt practices such as gratitude, forgiveness, and meditation on scripture, which can enhance the healing process and contribute to a balanced life.
- By integrating faith and herbalism, Christian herbalists offer a compassionate and comprehensive approach to health care. They serve as beacons of hope and healing, reminding their clients of the interconnectedness of body, mind, and spirit. Through their work, they honor God's creation and inspire others to cultivate a deeper relationship with Him, promoting a life of wellness and spiritual fulfillment.

# THE ROLE OF CHRISTIAN HERBALISTS

- Christian herbalists are essential in promoting holistic health through the use of natural remedies for various ailments. They believe that God has equipped us with all we need to sustain our health, and that by harnessing the power of herbs and plants, we can aid our bodies in self-healing. Often, Christian herbalists collaborate with conventional medical practitioners to create a well-rounded approach to healthcare. By integrating their deep-rooted faith with botanical knowledge, Christian herbalists provide a unique perspective that emphasizes the interconnectedness of body, mind, and spirit. They view the natural world as a testament to God's provision, seeing each plant as a gift with potential healing properties. This belief encourages a respect for nature and a responsibility to use its resources wisely.
- In their practice, Christian herbalists often begin by assessing the individual needs of their clients, considering not only physical symptoms but also emotional and spiritual well-being. They may recommend specific herbs tailored to the person's condition, such as chamomile for relaxation or echinacea to boost immunity, and provide guidance on their safe and effective use. Additionally, they emphasize the importance of lifestyle choices, such as proper nutrition and stress management, as integral components of maintaining health.
- Furthermore, Christian herbalists often incorporate prayer and spiritual counsel into their practice, seeking divine guidance to support their clients' healing journeys. This holistic approach not only addresses physical health but also aims to foster a deeper relationship with God and a greater sense of peace and purpose.
- Ultimately, Christian herbalists serve as compassionate healers who offer a blend of ancient wisdom and spiritual insight, helping individuals achieve a balanced and harmonious state of health. Through their work, they inspire others to see the beauty and potential of God's creation, encouraging a lifestyle that honors both the body and the spirit.

# INTEGRATING PRAYER AND SCRIPTURE

- A fundamental aspect of Christian herbalism is the incorporation of prayer and scripture into the healing journey. Christian herbalists believe that by seeking divine guidance and wisdom, they can better discern the needs of their patients and deliver more effective treatments. They frequently pray with their patients prior to administering herbal remedies and may include scripture readings during their consultations.
- Christian herbalists present a distinctive healing model that intertwines herbalism with Christian teachings. By employing natural remedies, embracing prayer and scripture, and recognizing each person as a whole being, Christian herbalists empower their patients to attain optimal health and wellness in body, mind, and spirit. If you are in search of a holistic healthcare approach that acknowledges God as the ultimate healer, consider reaching out to a Christian herbalist today.
- Through their compassionate guidance and holistic care, Christian herbalists offer more than just physical remedies; they provide a pathway to spiritual enrichment and emotional support. By understanding the interconnectedness of body, mind, and spirit, these practitioners help patients to not only overcome health challenges but also to find peace and balance in their lives.
- Christian herbalists encourage patients to embrace a lifestyle that reflects gratitude for the natural world, advocating for sustainable practices and mindful living. They emphasize the importance of nurturing the soul through prayer, meditation, and reflection, fostering a deeper relationship with God as an integral part of the healing process.
- In a world where modern medicine often overlooks the spiritual dimensions of health, Christian herbalists stand as a bridge between tradition and faith, offering a comprehensive approach that honors the Creator's wisdom. Through their work, they inspire others to see health as a gift from God, one that should be cherished and cultivated with love, respect, and faith.
- Whether you are dealing with a specific health issue or seeking to enhance your overall well-being, a Christian herbalist can provide you with personalized guidance and support. Their approach not only aims to heal the body but also to uplift the spirit and renew the mind, helping you to experience a fuller, more vibrant life in harmony with God's creation.

# PRINCIPLES OF CHRISTIAN HERBALISM

- Christian herbalists operate under a distinct set of principles that shape their practice. These include honoring God as the ultimate healer, valuing the natural world and its resources, and treating each person as a unique individual with specific needs. Additionally, Christian herbalists hold a strong belief in the power of prayer and the significance of seeking God's guidance in their endeavors. They view the integration of faith and herbal knowledge as a sacred responsibility, ensuring that their practices reflect both spiritual and scientific wisdom. By emphasizing the importance of using herbs with intention and care, Christian herbalists strive to align their treatments with biblical teachings and ethical standards.
- Another key principle is the commitment to education and empowerment. Christian herbalists aim to educate their clients about the benefits and proper use of herbal remedies, fostering self-awareness and encouraging individuals to take an active role in their own health care. This involves sharing knowledge about the properties of various herbs and their potential impacts on the body, always with a focus on safety and efficacy.
- Moreover, Christian herbalists often adopt a holistic approach, considering not just the physical symptoms but also the emotional and spiritual well-being of their clients. They recognize that true healing encompasses the whole person, and thus they incorporate practices that nurture the spirit, such as prayer, meditation, and reflection on scripture.
- In their practice, Christian herbalists also prioritize sustainability and stewardship of the earth. They advocate for the responsible sourcing and use of herbs, understanding that caring for the natural world is an expression of gratitude for God's creation. This involves choosing ethically harvested plants and promoting practices that protect and preserve the environment for future generations.
- In summary, the principles of Christian herbalism are deeply rooted in faith, respect for nature, and a commitment to holistic health. By honoring these principles, Christian herbalists seek to offer compassionate care that reflects the love and grace of God, helping individuals to achieve balance and wholeness in their lives.

# BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF HERBS

The Bible provides us with many examples of good food choices that can help us achieve optimal health. Here are 10 healing foods from the Bible that you can add to your diet:

1. Throughout the Bible, small fruits like figs, grapes, and pomegranates were used widely in beverages, cakes, or eaten as fresh fruit themselves.
    a. Pomegranates: Rich in antioxidants, vitamins, and minerals, pomegranates are a great source of nutrition that can help keep your body healthy and vibrant. Pomegranates have high anti-inflammatory, antioxidant, and even anti-tumor properties.
    b. Figs: Rich in fiber, vitamins, and minerals, figs are a delicious and nutritious fruit that can help maintain healthy blood pressure and lower the risk of heart disease. Loaded with minerals and vitamins like Vitamin A, K, and E, fresh figs are also low in calories and high in fiber.
    c. Grapes: contain resveratrol, a powerful antioxidant known for guarding against colon and prostate cancer as well as reducing stroke risk.
2. Honey: Known for its antibacterial properties, honey is not only a great natural sweetener, but it can also help fight infections and promote healing. Raw honey was a highly valued asset in the Bible. When God gave the Israelite people their promised land, it was described as a land flowing with milk and honey—a fertile agricultural area that could produce amazing foods, including bees with raw honey. Not only was honey nutritious and filling, but it was also a valued gift and a sweet metaphor for God's Word. Psalm 119:103 NIV describes how sweet God's words are to the taste, even sweeter than honey to the mouth.
3. Olive oil: High in healthy fats and antioxidants, olive oil is a staple in the Mediterranean diet and can help reduce inflammation and protect against chronic diseases. Olive oil was plentiful in Bible times due to the abundant crop of olive trees that continue to bear fruit even into old age. The Garden of Gethsemane, where Jesus prayed for God's will to be done the night before His crucifixion, is known for its gnarled, twisted olive trees. Green olives produced the best fruit and oil. Olives made delicious side dishes pickled or in a relish. The versatile, pressed olive oil was used in baking bread as well as in a salve for wounds, softening skin, in lamps, or even as a sacred anointing oil for kings.
4. Fish: Rich in omega-3 fatty acids, fish is a great source of protein that can help reduce inflammation and improve heart health. Fish is a highly nutritious food that was highly valued in biblical times. In fact, God specified in Leviticus 11:9 TLB that people could eat any fish with fins and scales, whether from rivers or seas. Additionally, fish was a staple in Jesus' day, and at least seven of His disciples were fishermen. On various occasions, He ate fish with His disciples and performed two miracles using a boy's lunch of small fish and bread loaves to feed thousands of people.
5. Vegetables: The Bible is full of references to vegetables, and for good reason. Vegetables are loaded with vitamins, minerals, and fiber, and can help protect against a variety of chronic diseases.
    a. Garlic: With its powerful anti-inflammatory and antibacterial properties, garlic is a versatile ingredient that can be used in many dishes to improve both taste and health.
6. Sprouted Grains and Breads In the Bible, bread appears repeatedly as the substance of life. Jesus even referred to Himself as the "Bread of Life." The bread in Bible times used none of the modern and damaging refining methods of today. The kind of nutritious bread they served often involved the sprouting of natural grains and was a basic part of their diets. Whole grain sourdough and sprouted-grain breads involve the soaking or fermenting of grains overnight until the seeds are partially sprouted. This process actually makes these carbohydrates more easily digestible.

# BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF HERBS

7. Goat Milk and Products Raw goat milk and cheese were plentiful in Bible times and were not pasteurized like our modern food. More easily digestible than cow's milk, goat's milk also has less lactose and contains multiple vitamins, enzymes, and proteins. According to Jordan Rubin, 65% of the world's population drinks goat's milk. It can help in the treatment of inflammatory diseases, is a complete protein, and is also useful in soaps.

8. Beans and Lentils Beans or lentils (legumes) were served widely in the Old Testament, probably since they are such good sources of protein. Legumes are plentiful in folate, especially important to pregnant women, are good antioxidants, and are low in saturated fats.

Lentils: A great source of protein, fiber, and complex carbohydrates, lentils are a nutritious food that can help regulate blood sugar levels and promote digestive health.

9. Nuts Pistachio and almond nuts, both found in the Bible, are low-calorie snacks. Pistachio nuts are high as antioxidants and contain more lutein (1000%) than other nuts. Almonds, mentioned several times in the Bible, are one of the highest protein and fiber nuts and contain manganese, magnesium, and calcium, necessary ingredients for the body.

Almonds: High in protein, healthy fats, and antioxidants, almonds are a great snack that can help reduce inflammation and support brain function.

10. Flax Flax was used with linen in the Bible to make clothes. But it also had great medicinal value because of its high fiber, Omega-3 fatty acids, protein, and lignan count. It contains one of the highest plant sources of lignans, almost 800 times more than any other. These help as antioxidants, in maintaining blood sugar, cholesterol, and even in cancer prevention.

Spices, Seasonings, and Herbs In the Old and New Testament, scores of spices were used as both food and medicines, as well as in making perfumes or incense, and were given as expensive, royal gifts. Cinnamon, known for its aromatic fragrance, as a spice has one of the highest antioxidant values known. Garlic is often linked to helping heart and immune issues. Other spices of the Bible include coriander, frankincense, mint, dill, balm, aloes, myrrh, and rue. Each contained healing properties such as promoting digestion, aiding the immune system, relieving pain, or fighting infections.

Incorporating these healing foods into your diet can help you achieve optimal health and wellness. Additionally, it is important to eat "grass-fed" and organic products to protect from harmful antibiotics or pesticides. By honoring God's wisdom and using these foods, we can keep our bodies healthy as temples of the Holy Ghost.

Herbs & their Uses

God has placed thousands of plants on Earth. You just need to know how to use them, and it is my hope to teach you exactly that! I want to inspire you to try some of the herbs and spices you will learn about today. God's plants aid and support the body processes that God designed. The plant-derived "medicine" you read about today was discussed eons ago in biblical times. The herbs from the Scriptures have medicinal phytonutrients (constituents). I believe that we can achieve optimal wellness with what God provided for us from the beginning.

Genesis 1:29

"And God said, Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, and every tree, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you it shall be for meat." King James Version (KJV)

# THE BIBLICAL FOUNDATION OF HERBAL MEDICINE

The Bible provides timeless wisdom on health, emphasizing the importance of caring for the body, practicing moderation, and trusting in God for strength and healing. The King James Version (KJV) contains many passages that highlight both physical and spiritual well-being.

The Body as God's Temple

Scripture teaches that the body is sacred and should be treated with respect and care.

1 Corinthians 6:19-20

"What? know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own? For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's."

Health Through Obedience

Obedience to God's commandments is often linked to health and blessing.

Exodus 15:26

"If thou wilt diligently hearken to the voice of the LORD thy God, and wilt do that which is right in his sight, and wilt give ear to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of these diseases upon thee, which I have brought upon the Egyptians: for I am the LORD that healeth thee."

The Value of a Cheerful Heart

Emotional and spiritual health are connected to physical well-being.

Proverbs 17:22

"A merry heart doeth good like a medicine: but a broken spirit drieth the bones."

Moderation and Self-Control

The Bible warns against gluttony and excess, encouraging moderation for good health.

Proverbs 23:20-21

"Be not among winebibbers; among riotous eaters of flesh: For the drunkard and the glutton shall come to poverty: and drowsiness shall clothe a man with rags."

Trusting God for Healing

God is the ultimate source of healing and restoration.

Psalm 103:2-3

"Bless the LORD, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits: Who forgiveth all thine iniquities; who healeth all thy diseases."

Jeremiah 30:17

"For I will restore health unto thee, and I will heal thee of thy wounds, saith the LORD."

The Importance of Rest

Rest is essential for health, and God established the Sabbath as a time of renewal.

Exodus 20:9-10

"Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work: But the seventh day is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates."

# THE BIBLICAL FOUNDATION OF HERBAL MEDICINE

Nourishment and Provision

God provides food and resources for sustaining health.

Genesis 1:29

"And God said, Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, and every tree, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you it shall be for meat."

Ezekiel 47:12

"And by the river upon the bank thereof, on this side and on that side, shall grow all trees for meat, whose leaf shall not fade, neither shall the fruit thereof be consumed: it shall bring forth new fruit according to his months, because their waters they issued out of the sanctuary: and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine."

# WOMEN IN THE BIBLE AND THEIR STORIES ABOUT HEALTH

The Bible highlights several women whose lives and struggles are connected to health, healing, and restoration. Their stories provide lessons of faith, perseverance, and God's power to heal both physically and spiritually.

The Woman with the Issue of Blood

Mark 5:25-29

"And a certain woman, which had an issue of blood twelve years, And had suffered many things of many physicians, and had spent all that she had, and was nothing bettered, but rather grew worse, When she had heard of Jesus, came in the press behind, and touched his garment. For she said, If I may touch but his clothes, I shall be whole. And straightway the fountain of her blood was dried up; and she felt in her body that she was healed of that plague."

- Suffered for 12 years with a chronic condition.
- Spent all her resources seeking healing but found none.
- By faith, she touched Jesus' garment and was instantly healed.
- Lesson: Faith in Christ brings healing when human efforts fail.

Hannah's Struggle with Infertility

1 Samuel 1:10-11, 19-20

"And she was in bitterness of soul, and prayed unto the LORD, and wept sore. And she vowed a vow, and said, O LORD of hosts, if thou wilt indeed look on the affliction of thine handmaid, and remember me, and not forget thine handmaid, but wilt give unto thine handmaid a man child, then I will give him unto the LORD all the days of his life, and there shall no razor come upon his head."

- Hannah experienced deep sorrow due to infertility.
- She poured out her heart in prayer to God.
- God answered her prayer, and she gave birth to Samuel.
- Lesson: God hears the cries of the brokenhearted and can bring healing and restoration.

The Bent-Over Woman Healed by Jesus

Luke 13:11-13

"And, behold, there was a woman which had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years, and was bowed together, and could in no wise lift up herself. And when Jesus saw her, he called her to him, and said unto her, Woman, thou art loosed from thine infirmity. And he laid his hands on her: and immediately she was made straight, and glorified God."

- Suffered for 18 years with a crippling condition.
- Jesus healed her on the Sabbath, showing His compassion.
- She immediately glorified God after her healing.
- Lesson: Jesus brings freedom from long-term suffering and restores health.

Naaman's Servant Girl (A Messenger of Healing)

2 Kings 5:2-3

"And the Syrians had gone out by companies, and had brought away captive out of the land of Israel a little maid; and she waited on Naaman's wife. And she said unto her mistress, Would God my lord were with the prophet that is in Samaria! for he would recover him of his leprosy."

- A young servant girl pointed Naaman, who had leprosy, to the prophet Elisha.
- Though not sick herself, she played a key role in directing someone to healing.
- Lesson: God can use anyone, even the overlooked, to bring hope and healing to others.